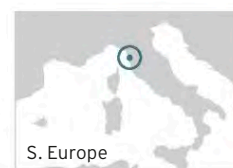




Leaning Tower of Pisa and Duomo

An iconic bell tower sharing Pisa's "Square of Miracles" with other marble-clad marvels of medieval architecture



Known for its unintended tilt, the Leaning Tower of Pisa is one of Italy's foremost attractions. It was planned in the 12th century as a free-standing bell tower, or campanile, for the Duomo—a magnificent cathedral built in the Romanesque style some 200 years earlier.

The crowning glory

The Duomo itself stands in a large walled piazza, with expanses of lawn between the paved areas. The piazza also contains the Baptistry, and on its northern side the

Camposanto Monumentale ("monumental cemetery"). All of these buildings are of extraordinary architectural merit in their own right, but because of its tilt, the Campanile erected behind the cathedral has eclipsed their reputation.

Construction of the tower, designed to be 185 ft (56 m) tall, started in 1173. Its unstable foundations caused it to list to the south after only three floors had been built, and only after many delays was the building completed in the 14th century.



△ RELIEF PANELS

The pulpit of the Duomo features sculpted marble panels depicting scenes from the life of Christ, such as this Slaughter of the Innocents.